



MONTHLY UPDATE

Standards: monthly update, July 2026

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23 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

Algeria

Progress on a national accreditation, conformity and certification network and its GEOLAB platform was reviewed at the 23 July Council of Government sitting.

Benin

Interoperability gained its rules and its gatekeeper in the same month. The [conditions of access to the national exchange were published on 28 July](#): registration in the interoperable-solutions catalogue, demonstrated data governance, compatible infrastructure, and a convention per exchange naming data, purposes, responsibilities and security measures — and, for a private body, an adhesion convention plus data-protection authority authorisation before first connection. That places the authority inside the technical onboarding path rather than at the end of it as a complaint channel. No fee schedule, processing time or count of authorised participants is stated. The [national root certification authority and trust services are operating](#), and architecture and application-integration referentials went out to consultation on the same date, intended to end siloed platform-building.

Cape Verde

The Prime Minister told Parliament during the State of the Nation debate on 31 July 2026 that the statistics institute had produced falsified data, and announced an independent evaluation to establish alleged interference and manipulation. On 3 August the institute's board rejected the allegations clearly, firmly and categorically, and said it was available to receive any external evaluation mission or peer review, undertaking to supply all technical documentation ([both accounts](#)). Nothing is established about the evaluation's terms of reference, who conducts it, when it reports, or whether its findings will be published. The dispute is not new — anonymous technicians raised it in August 2025 and the institute rejected it in September 2025 — and the two accounts remain unreconciled.

Cote d'Ivoire

On 29 July the agency [set a target of 1,200 certified cyber-security specialists in three years](#), with 88 auditors certified that day.

DR Congo

The telecommunications regulator set on 22 July a [binding escalation path for consumer complaints: the operator first, up to 30 working days, then referral to the regulator](#).

Egypt

Transfer-pricing guidance [has not been revised since 2018](#), and appeal committees relying on the statutory provision requiring a minister-approved guide have cancelled some penalties. The account is a named practitioner's, not the tax authority's.

Equatorial Guinea

A quality-of-service regulation of 2018 is [confirmed in force on the regulator's own legislation index](#). Only its title and date are held, not its text; the same index lists an inspection and sanctions regulation of 2020 and a broadband-market update of February 2026, neither of which the ledger carries as a row.

Eswatini

Asked on 4 August how online publications comply with the data-protection law, the ICT ministry [answered that implementation, enforcement and oversight do not fall within its direct mandate](#) but are vested in ESCCOM.

Ethiopia

[National livestock data standards were endorsed and cascaded on 29 July](#) on a training-of-trainers model, with more than 300 experts and data collectors trained. The national identity credential is separately [described as the flagship deployment of the open-source identity platform it is built on](#) and the reference implementation others point to.

Ghana

The central bank's [cyber and information security directive is in force](#) as the country's first comprehensive artificial-intelligence governance framework for financial institutions, carrying cloud-security rules, proportionality by size and risk, and mandatory board-level accountability. Against that, the communications minister [named a national data exchange hub again on 29 July](#) as something government plans to establish, with no design, cost or timetable, and without saying whether it revives the system launched in 2009 or replaces it.

Kenya

Two days after introducing the equipment distributor licence, the Communications Authority introduced vendor class-licence rules requiring a twelve-month warranty and three years of retained sales records. The data-protection regulator launched a quality management system on 14 July, phased toward external certification.

Libya

On 2 August the Municipal Guard's Investigation and Information Gathering Office, acting on Central Bank instructions and with the Ministry of Economy and Trade, [said any surcharge on card payment is prohibited](#) and that the displayed price is the final price. [Complaints had reported spreads reaching 20% in some clinics and medical centres.](#)

Malawi

On 3 August the copyright society's blank media levy distribution was reported to rest on records submitted by licensed disc-burning centres rather than on digital consumption, with a proposal to key distribution to digital consumption voted down at an annual general meeting.

Mauritius

And the model-as-a-service work billed as a telecom first was [announced on 20 July](#) as work to define conformance criteria for a framework that does not yet exist.

Mozambique

The regulator opened a free public device-identity lookup on 4 August, checked against a registry held by an industry association ([regulator notice](#)). The notice sets out no type approval, import control, blocking regime or penalty.

Niger

On 27 July the regulator's verification campaign opened against the [mises en demeure served on all four mobile operators on 10 June 2026](#). [Persistent breach exposes an operator to a fine of 1 to 3% of prior-year turnover, partial or total licence suspension, a shortened licence term, or definitive withdrawal by the Council of Ministers.](#)

Nigeria

The technology agency approved a [software quality assurance framework](#) on 30 July making independent third-party testing a mandatory condition of IT project clearance — full operation is set for Q2 2027 and no licensed testing organisation is yet on file.

Rwanda

The [government-wide enterprise architecture framework, version 2.1](#), is in force to govern ICT architecture [standards](#) and is now held in excerpt. It is distinct from the interoperability framework named in earlier academic work, for which the base still holds no separate instrument.

Senegal

Senegal adopted [non-binding Francophone West African AI governance guidelines on 6 July](#).

Sierra Leone

The [national open-source software policy for the public sector is in force](#), approved in 2025. No compliance or adoption reporting has been published against it.

South Africa

Parliament's communications committee [prefers strengthening the existing regulators through the ICT and media regulators forum to creating the four artificial-intelligence bodies the withdrawn draft policy proposed](#). The forum was launched in 2024 and no instrument establishing its powers is held.

The Prudential Authority's 2025/26 report, reported on 16 July, [embeds AI, cloud, cyber and data-offshoring into bank supervision](#) and records a first nationwide AI-adoption survey naming regulatory uncertainty, AI skills and governance as the barriers. A dedicated framework is expected in 2026; none is published.

Togo

The same Council of Ministers session of 30 July [adopted a decree instituting a national conformity-assessment mechanism](#) covering pre-market assessment and traceability for local and imported products, again with no number, text or entry-into-force date published. Against that, the [national frequency allocation plan is held in full](#): 197 pages transposing the 2023 world radiocommunication conference, with an explicit civil and military sharing column and new bands for 5G, high-altitude platforms and inter-satellite links.

Uganda

On 30 July the transformation programme secretariat reported that its review of quarterly submissions under the fourth development plan [found gaps and inconsistencies in the data ministries and agencies submit through the national monitoring and evaluation system](#), naming no error rate and no remediation date.

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